

Uloom Al Hadith

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Start Date: Oct 28th 2025
End Date:

Chapter 1+2: Intro

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Date Covered: 10/28 @ 1410, 10/29 1400, 11/4 @ 1045, 11/4 0205

Key Terms

Diraya: understanding, interpretation, and application of hadith

Riwaya: details of transmission and preservation of hadith

Sanad: the chain of narration. Originally means to lean on something/ the knees. Refers to the connection of narrations. Hadith of jibreel meeting the prophet ﷺ, the word asnad is used to describe their knees.

Mathan: the wording of the hadith. Example: Riyadh Al Salihin for example is focused on deriving meanings.

Hadith: Statements, actions, approvals and descriptions of the Prophet ﷺ. 'Hadith' is often interchangeable with khabr and athr.

Muhsala hadith: terminology of hadith, gradings

Garibul Hadith: definitions of words that come in hadith

Nasikh and mansukh: abrogations and rulings

Afaal: statements

Afwaal: actions

Taqreer: approvals

Siffa: descriptions of the Prophet ﷺ

Chapter 1: The Importance of the Sunnah

Date Covered: 10/28 @ 1410

Key terms

Athr: Specific to tabi'een and others. But also used interchangeably with hadith and khabr.

Ghayr matlu: unrecited revelation

Khabr: Specific to sahaba. But also used interchangeably with hadith and athr

Sunnah: a paved path. Meaning depends on who is saying it (see notes below)

The Importance of the Sunnah (Evidence in Quran and Hadith)

- **Following the sunnah is faith (Surah Nisa Ayah 65)**
 - *But no, by your Lord, they will not [truly] believe until they make you, [O Muhammad], judge concerning that over which they dispute among themselves and then find within themselves no discomfort from what you have judged and submit in [full, willing] submission. (4:65)*
- Disobedience is not from faith (Surah Al Azhab Ayah 37)
 - *It is not for a believing man or a believing woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decided a matter, that they should [thereafter] have any choice about their affair. And whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger has certainly strayed into clear error. (33:37)*
- Disobedience is a source of fitna (Surah An Nur Ayah 63)
 - *Do not make [your] calling of the Messenger among yourselves as the call of one of you to another. Already Allah knows those of you who slip away, concealed by others. So let those beware who dissent from the Prophet's order, lest fitnah strike them or a painful punishment. (24:63)*
- No faith until we follow the sunnah
 - *None of you have faith until his desires comply with what I have brought."* ([Source](#))

The Importance of Preserving Hadith

The Prophet ﷺ said

Never a Prophet had been sent before me by Allah towards his nation who had not among his people (his) disciples and companions who followed his ways and obeyed his command. Then there came after them their successors who said whatever they did not practise, and practised whatever they were not commanded to do. He who strove against them with his hand was a believer: he who strove against them with his tongue was a believer, and he who strove against them with his heart was a believer and beyond that there is no faith even to the extent of a mustard seed. (Muslim 50)

- **Attempts at Distortion:** We can understand from this hadith that it is a pattern of humanity for people to try and distort the religion.
- **Need for Protectors:** Those who have faith will be the ones protecting.
- The Prophet ﷺ mentioned this concept in many other hadiths as well:

"This knowledge will be carried by the trustworthy of every successive generation, refuting the corruption of extremists, the distortions of falsifiers, and the interpretations of the ignorant." ([Source](#))

- **Must be Learned from Teachers:** Sunnah must be learned from others. Hadith should not be read without its context or learned without teachers
 - Ex: drinking water standing up. The Prophet ﷺ allows and prohibits it in different circumstances.

The Prophet ﷺ said

They will be young in age, lacking wisdom, and using the best of language inappropriately. ([Bukhari 3611](#))

And in another hadith the Prophet ﷺ says that they say the words of the best of humans but they use it to distort the lifestyle and present their own ideas and desires (source missing TS 1421)

Famous Statement of the Salaf

The Quran needs the sunnah more than the sunnah needs the Quran

- **Sunnah is the foundation of muslim lifestyle:** Removing the Quran from the world would not affect muslim lifestyle that much due to its preservation within sunnah.

Meaning of the word Sunnah

- Meaning a paved path
- has the connotation of cutting and piercing.
- Depends on who is saying it
- **seen/asnan:** meaning teeth
- **Sinaan:** meaning spear

- In a hadith, the Prophet ﷺ uses word play saying we should be grabbing the sunnah by teeth.
- **Context**
 - Scholars of fiqh use the word sunnah as a category of obligation, sunnah vs fard vs wajib
 - Scholars of aqeedah will say ahlul sunnah vs ahlul bidah
 - Scholars of tafsir will say sunnah vs quran
 - Scholars of hadith will say sunnah vs hadith

Khabr: Specific to sahaba. But also used interchangeably with hadith and athr.

Athr: Specific to tabi'een and others. But also used interchangeably with hadith and khabr.

Ghayr matlu: unrecited revelation

The Harm of Leaving Sunnah

- Abu Dharr was once asked if the Prophet ﷺ was alive is there anything he would not do (that they did)? He got extremely angry and said "Is there anything you do that the Prophet ﷺ did?" ([Waddah 1/130](#))
- Quote from Hasan Al Basri: It is reported from Al-Hasan Al-Basri that he said, "If a man from amongst the Salaf were to be sent forth today, he would not recognize anything from Islam." He put his hand on his cheek and added, "Except this prayer (salah)."
- They are comparing to a very high standard of purity in deen
- Virtue of Reviving Sunnahs
 - Whoever revives a portion of my sunnah will have the reward of shuhada.
 - Giving life to sunnah after it is lost is very virtuous.
 - Example: Generosity. Generosity in current western society is very strange.
- Sunnahs of Interactions: The fast disappearing sunnahs are those pertaining to akhlaq.
- The attacks on hadith
 - Hadith is the most convenient way for malintentioned people to attack the deen.

- However, even many orientalist scholars have studied hadith preservation and noticed the extreme levels of caution in it.
- **Goal:** understand the preservation and protection of what the Prophet ﷺ has said and done.

Understanding the Quran through Hadith

- Many ayat in the Quran are difficult to understand without context.

Model Behavior

Surah Al Ahzab Ayah 21

- Surah Al Ahzab was revealed in the aftermath of the battle, in which muslims fled unable to comprehend that a victory was possible.
- This ayah appears in the context of ayat about battle.
- This ayah appeared in a time of peak difficulty.
- Uswa
 - comes from roof, aiysa from foundational pillar
 - Uswa is something that gives your existence meaning and purpose
 - So taking the Prophet ﷺ out of our lives would remove it
- Raja
 - Used in the quran to mean fear
 - Where does the translation of hope come from? Raja is an apprehensive kind of hope. Hope with fear of loss.
 - Other words for hope: amaal (long distance hope), amani (delusional hope, plural of umniya)
 - So someone who is hopefully afraid of Allah
- These are the people who should be following the Prophet ﷺ
- When you can identify if a person can follow the sunnah
 - Funeral (times of sadness)
 - Wedding (times of extreme happiness)
 - Divorce (times of extreme tension)
- So this ayah being revealed in a time of extreme difficulty is significant to its meaning.

Chapter 3: Preservation and Compilation

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Date Covered: 11/4 @ 10:45, 11/6 0220, 11/11 @ 1400

- The difference between the Quran and hadith is that the Quran needs to be preserved exactly. Hadith does however include ghayr matlu (unrecited revelation)

Summary of the Phases

1. The life of the Prophet ﷺ
2. The Sahaba
3. The Tabi'een
4. The structured or formal compilation

Phase 1: The Prophets Life

Methods of Preservation

- **No Writing**
 - No writing in Mecca or first few years of Madina
 - **Hadith:** The Prophet ﷺ prohibited sahaba from writing down ahadith to prevent it being mixed with Quran, and commanded them to erase it.
- **Memorization/Oral Transmission**
 - Abdullah ibn Amr ibn Aas asked, and the Prophet ﷺ said everything that comes from my mouth is true.
 - For the same reasons as the Quran (writing materials were scarce and literacy levels low)
 - Jaaber narrates that after the Prophet ﷺ left, they would gather and discuss.
 - Sahaba, during the life of the Prophet ﷺ, compiled ahadith
- **Permission for writing given to specific people**
 - Abu Huraira would write everything, and other sahaba prohibited.
 - Specific people given permission (like that given to Abdullah ibn Amr ibn Aas, who wrote the most and knew the most)
 - Then generic permission

Virtues of Teaching Hadith

- Virtues are a source of motivation.

Narrated by Anas bin Malik that the Prophet ﷺ said: May Allah cause to flourish a slave who hears my words and understands them, then he conveys them from me, There are those who have knowledge but no understanding and there may be those who convey knowledge to those who may have more understanding of it than they do.

- **Sahaba story:** A group of men were competing to see who could jump a distance of water. He was old, and they asked him how he was able to stay so fit. He said it was because he spent his life studying and transmitting hadith.
- **Mufti Aasim Story:** His teacher Sheikh Yusuf would receive all kinds of powerful visitors. Near the end of his life, he was almost fully hunched over and losing his memory, however he would quote specific details from hadith. Mufti Aasim attributes it to the dua of the Prophet ﷺ.
- **Lesson about Sharing:** People can have better understanding than you. Someone who has heard it secondhand might have a better understanding, so share with as many people as you can.
- **Teaching Tips from Sunnah:** Sheikh Abdul Fattah wrote a book called The Teaching Prophet which mentions 40 or so methods the Prophet ﷺ used for teaching people
 - Clear sentences
 - Reminders on set dates
 - Brevity
 - Basics before specifics (salah, then other commands)
 - Prioritization and specific roles (roles given to specific sahaba to prioritize certain things)
 - Imagery/Comparison (ex: dunya worth less than a small dead goat, drawing a line in the sand)
 - Encouragement
 - Strict warnings against fabrication (fabrication leading to Jhannam)
 - Observation
 - Encouraged the sahaba to watch him and learn from him, hadith: "learn from me now because you are going to be asked and people will learn from you"
 - Anas RA prayed behind Umar ibn Abdul Aziz and said he prayed just like the Prophet ﷺ.

Phase 2: The Companions

Time Stamp: 11/4 @ 1110

- Sahifas of Hadith
 - Sahaba had their personal written collections of hadith
- Abu Bakr's Caliphate
 - No coordinated effort to organize hadith.
 - No time, place, or need.
 - A chaotic era
- Umar RA's Caliphate
 - He thinks about writing and then he decides not to because it might draw away attention from the Quran, and because he was worried about fabrication.
- Uthman RA's Caliphate
 - Similar situation of chaos
 - No formal efforts.

Sahaba that had Hadith Written

- Abdullah ibn Amr ibn Aas
 - Mujahid bin Jaber says he went to the house of Abdullah ibn Amr ibn Aas and he reached for his sahifa when Abdullah pushed him away. He said his land and his sahifa were his reason to be alive.
 - Abdullah ibn Amr ibn Aas knew the most and had written the most but did not verbally narrate.
 - Name: Sahif At Us Sadiqa
- Ali RA
- Abdullah Ibn Abbas

Sahaba that Narrated

- Abu Huraira: 5374
- Abdullah Ibn Umar: 2630
- Anas bin Malik: 2286
- Aisha RA: 2210
- Ibn Abbas: 1660
- *Jaaber ibn Abdullah
- *Abu Said Al Kudri

Attacking the Sahaba as Narrators

- It is not a point of aqeedah that every word the prophet ﷺ said is preserved but it is a point to believe in the preservation of the Quran's understanding
- Opponents of islam will try to attack the sahaba. They reject their narrations and the existence of sunnah
 - Say that sahaba left islam
 - That they had personal motivations for fabricating ahadith
- How do we know it is not true?
 - There is no proof
 - Allah says he is pleased with the generation that came with the Prophet ﷺ. Therefore they are divinely assured to be reliable people.
 - It does not makes sense for the understandings of the Quran and Prophet ﷺ to be cut off

Sahaba's Methods of Preservation

Method # 1: Limiting the Number of Narrations

- Avoiding excessive narration was a mechanism of preservation.
- Narrators were limited. Only a few people were allowed to narrate.
 - This limited the sources of information and allowed them to maintain its truth.
- Abu Said Al Kudri knocked 3 times, and then left, said the Prophet ﷺ said to leave after knocking 3 times. Umar RA said if you don't produce a witness for this narration I will make an example out of you.
 - Shows how seriously they took narration

Method #2: Wording

- Sahaba will be cautious in the way they narrate. If they do not have the exact wording they will make it clear by saying the Prophet ﷺ said something similar.
 - Ashr Bashr did not mention the Prophet ﷺ by name just to be cautious. Narration that someone who spent weeks with him did not notice him narrating even once.
- "I heard the Prophet ﷺ say "this" or "this"" might be how they phrased it.
 - Synonyms were a common way of narrating

Method #3: Caution in Choice

- Sahaba would warn the tabi'een to be careful with which ahadith they share and how they share it.
- Picking the right time, place, and method was important.
- They would avoid narrating very specific or out of place things, instead focusing on generalities.

Phase 3: Tabi'een

- Mission to make an official collection as more sahaba passed away
- Umar ibn Abdul Aziz.

About Umar

- The 5th of the Khulafa of Rashidin
- Muawaiyya then more between Ali and Umar, but they call him the 5th because he was similar to them
- Banu Umayya was corrupt but he changed things
- Year 99-101
- Governor of Madina before becoming Caliph
- Great Grandson of Umar RA
- Story of how Umar RA married his grandson to Umar ibn Abdul Aziz's mother.
- Umar RA overhears a conversation, asks for their daughter. 1424
- Umar - Aasim - Umm Aasim - Umar ibn Abdul Aziz
- Was very wealthy due to influential family
- He gave back all his gifts
- His wife was also from Banu Umayya, told her she can't keep any gifts
- He changed the system in khilafa
- Extreme prosperity under his reign

Decides Hadith needs to be Collected

- Sends letters to all kingdoms under his reign to send their best scholars for hadith compilation.
- The scholars of this time grew up with sahaba
- Ibn Shihab Az Zuhri from Madina was one scholar, who met many sahaba
 - Oversees the project
- Amr ibn Hazm
 - Another governor
- The compilations never get published but the scholars teach from them
- Muhaddithin requires that students hear the hadith directly from the scholar with the collection.

Umar ibn Abdul Aziz

- The compilation into fiqh

Students of the Tabi'een

- More formalized
 - Giving chapter headings
 - Imam Malik
- Next generation
 - Mostly students of Imam Ahmed
 - Goals are formalized

Chapter 4: Hadith Literature

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Date Covered: 11/11 @ 1400

Focus of this chapter: Know the terminology, definition, and an example.

Key Terms: Genres of Books of Hadith

- **Sahifa - Personal Collection**

- an individual persons hadith compilation
- Started in the life times of the sahaba
- Personal notes, no organization
- Earliest recorded hadith texts

- **Musannaf - Categorization like Encyclopedias**

- The word tasneef means categorization.
- **Defining Qualities**
 - chapter organization
 - Includes statements of all generations (the Prophet ﷺ, sahaba, tabi'een, and scholars who came after)
- You can consider them encyclopedias
- Sometimes includes the authors own statements
- Collections:
 - Muwatta of Imam Malik
 - Musannaf of 'Abd al-Razzaq
 - Musannaf of Ibn Abi Shaybah

- **Musnad - Categorized by Sahaba**

- Categorized by names of sahaba and the hadiths they narrated.
- The chapter might be called hadith of Abu Bakr, hadith of Umar, etc.
- The biggest one is the musnad compiled by Imam Ahmed.
- Organization varies. Some did it alphabetically, some by city, some by volume.

- **Jami'i - Comprehensive Topics**

- Means comprehensive
- Includes every major topic of islam
- 8 topics required to be considered a jami'i
 - Aqaid (Beliefs/Creed)
 - Ahkam (Legal rulings)
 - Siyar (History and Biography of the Prophet SAW)

- Adab (Social Etiquette)
 - Tafsir (Quranic Exegesis)
 - Ashrat (Signs of the Day of Judgement)
 - Fitān (Trials and Tribulations)
 - Manāqib (Virtues of the Companions)
- These categories are unofficial.
- **Sahih**
 - Sahih Bukhari and Muslim are the most famous
 - the author only includes narrations that they deem to be authentic
- **Sunan**
 - Based on genres of fiqh
 - Ex: Taharah (purification), salah (prayer), zakah (obligatory charity), sawm (fasting), hajj (pilgrimage), nikah (marriage), talaq (divorce), and bay' (transactions)
 - Books of fiqh were written before books of documentation, due to need
 - The books of hadith that were copied from books of fiqh were considered sunnan
 - Most famous
 - The Sunan of Abu Dawud
 - The Sunan of al-Nasa'i
 - The Sunan of Ibn Majah
- **Mu'jam**
 - Anything that is in alphabetical order
 - Some do it with names of sahaba, others by their teachers, others by narrators etc.
 - Most famous is Imam Thabarani
- **Mustadrak**
 - Like a DLC extension pack
 - Bukhari had a set of conditions on what met his standards. If someone later finds more hadith that meet those conditions, they will add them and write their own collection.
 - Adding to someone else's collection
 - Mustadrak of Imam Al Hakim. Not completed during his life, published much later.
- **Mustakhraj**
 - A very impressive genre that is difficult to write in.
 - Title given when a scholar documents a hadith, then someone else verifies it from a different chain but for their entire book.

- Sahih Bukhari and Sahih Muslim both have this
- Nice to see because you know that if the collection was lost the information would not be.
- **Juz**
 - A book of hadith that is only written about one topic
 - A juz' is a collection that focuses on the narrations of one single narrator or ahadith regarding one single theme or subject
 - A collection that focuses only on narrations from Abu Bakr RA would be called Juz' Abu Bakr.
 - Ex: Juz' Qiyam al-Layl by al-Marwazi. In this collection he gathers narrations on qiyam al-layl
- **Sharh**
 - Means commentary
 - Scholars wrote commentary on the hadith collections
 - Sharh can have their own "flavors"
 - This is one of the most important genres of hadith literature.
 - Commentaries were usually written on the more well-known and widely used hadith collections
 - A sharh serves 2 purposes
 - Assisting students in reading and understanding difficult phrases, names and meanings
 - Providing scholars an opportunity to elaborate in detail on any legal or historical issues they found relevant to a hadith
 - Sharh is to hadith with tafsir is to quran. Both carry the meaning of explanation.
 - Example: Imam Nawawi's commentary on Sahih Muslim

Extra Notes

- Hadith books must have a chain of narration through primary sources. Riyadh Al Salihin for example is a secondary source.
- Bukhari has a cryptic way of writing

Chapter 5: Well Known Hadith Works and Compilers

Chapter 5: Well Known Hadith Works and Compilers

Date Covered: 11/12 @ 1400

Imam Malik

Imam Malik

Dates Covered: 11/12 @ 1400, 11/13 @ 1100

Slide Notes

- The most famous musannaf that is taught today
 - Muwatta' means "the travelled path"
- Biography
 - Full Name: Imam Malik ibn Anas bin Malik ibn Abi Amir
 - Born: in Madinah in the year 92
 - Approximate, narrations vary
 - During Umar ibn Abdul Aziz's Khalifa
 - Year 93 Anas ibn Malik passed away
 - Death: in Madinah in the year 179
- One of the greatest scholars of hadith and fiqh
- Founder of one of the four main schools of thought
 - It was said about him, "No fatwa is to be given while Malik is in Madinah"
- Imam Malik was the grand teacher of Imam Bukhari.

The Muwatta

- It is a mixture of Prophetic hadith, rulings of Companions, the practice of the scholars of Madinah, and his own personal opinions.
- It contains 1,720 reports
 - 527 hadith
 - 613 statements of companions
 - 285 statements from successors
 - remaining are his own.
- Considered to be the most authentic book after the Quran, before the compilation of Sahih Bukhari

Birth and Lineage

- His birth is a famous story
 - Mother was pregnant with him for over 2 years and he had a full head of hair/full set of teeth when he was born. It was narrated by many people.

- He had some defects: very light blonde hair, pale skin, and blue eyes (supposedly albino).
- However he was generally healthy: tall, broad shouldered, and intimidating in stature later in life
- Lineage
 - His grandfather Abu Amr was alive with sahaba and helped compile Uthman's mushaf
 - His great grandfather used to live in Yemen and moved to Madina.
 - Generally from a long line of scholars
 - His older brother Nadr was a classmate of Imam Zuhri

Childhood and Early Interests

- He did not want to study hadith as a child
 - Used to hunt birds and play around
- His father asked him and his brother a question and he didn't know the answer.
 - He started studying out of sheer competition.
- His mother took a more active role in his studying after his father passed away
- His father was a wealthy merchant
 - He was never poor out of necessity or in desperate need.

Malik's Teachers

- Rabi'a ibn AbdurRahman (Rahi)
 - His mother told him to go to Rabi'a ibn AbdurRahman (Rahi) at age 12-13 to learn adhab and ilm
 - She famously tied his imama like a student of knowledge.
 - Imam Malik stayed with Rabi'a for years.
- Local to Madina
 - Malik was one of few scholars to not leave Madina
 - Didn't need to because he was learning directly from the children/grandchildren of sahaba
- AbdurRahman bin Urruz
 - Would go to his house to study
 - No official institutions at the time, knowledge mostly taught in houses
 - Malik would bribe his children to tell people who knocked at their door that their father is busy.

- Jaafer As Saadiq
 - the great-great grandson of the Prophet ﷺ through Ali/Fatima RA
 - Respected by Shias
- Imam Zuhri
 - Malik says he others would crowd around his house
- 7 Fuquha
 - Malik had narrations from all of them

Imam Malik's Career as a Teacher

- He did not teach in Madina until 70 of his teachers gave him approval.
 - Started at age 21
 - Continued learning from his own teachers in the meantime
 - Was pushed into the teaching position, not pursuing it out of his own volition
 - Lesson: Do not rush to teach, you do it when others push you into it
- Used to live in the same house as Abdullah ibn Masoud.
 - He would rent it, did not buy it

Imam Malik's Etiquette

- He was very particular about clothing
 - Would wear a new set of clothes to every class while donating his last set
 - Wanted scholars to have hayba (prestige/dignity)
 - Was very particular about dirty and torn clothing
 - Would wear his imama in the style of tahneek, which was a symbol of senior scholars (wraps under the chin and back into the imama)
- His appearance
 - Kept his head bald
 - Had a thick white beard in older age
- His presence
 - His majlis was like the gathering of a king
 - Governors who attended looked like children
- His habits
 - Would shower before every gathering
 - Would burn bukhoor
 - When people asked rude questions he would kick them out
 - He would teach near the rawda. "The person who is in this grave said..."

- Details on his appearance and adhab got passed down
 - A modern scholar who learned from Imam Malik's line of students said an old lady once wrote him a letter thanking him for his dress. She knew students of knowledge to always be asking for money but he proved otherwise (while following the sunnah of Imam Malik)
- Very serious and strict in nature
 - His students only saw him laugh one time, and it was when he was asked about gatherings of people dancing around
 - Two lizards crawled on him, one of them reaching his head while he was in class, and he did not flinch.
- Habits and strictness towards knowledge
 - Would start all his gatherings with the same dua (missed)
 - Someone came and sat in front of Imam Malik randomly to ask for a hadith and Malik chased him out
 - Malik's strictness was meant to establish reverence for the pursuit of knowledge.
- He had good relationships with his teachers
 - However he did not use that as an excuse to lower his seriousness towards them.
 - Lesson: Not giving every teacher their due respect is a sign of a lack of sincerity. We should take every teacher as a mode of connection to Allah.
- Extremely cautious of giving fatawa.
 - His face would change, and he would often say "I don't know"
 - He would see himself standing before jannah and jahannam. It was very intimidating for him. He had strong taqwa in answering questions
- He hated argumentation
 - Someone asked him, should they argue? And he said do not argue just inform
- He was isolated and secluded
 - He did not like hanging out with people
- He had strong frasa
 - He and Imam Shafi both had this skill
 - They would practice together
 - Sometimes they would guess different and both be right
 - One time a man passed by them and Malik said the man was a blacksmith while Shafi said carpenter, the man turned out to be both

- Malik's once gave advice to two teens. One teen to memorize quran (who later became an imam) and the other teen to be soft on people (who became a qadi)
- He was very skilled at reading people, even small children he just met.
- Someone asked him the best way to seek knowledge
 - Find a teacher you can spend all day with
 - Lesson: the title student of knowledge is given to somebody based on how they spend their time.
 - 12 hours in your day should be spent pursuing knowledge

End of Life

- Fitna of the Khilafa of Abbasid
 - This Khilafa, Malik and Hanifa were indirect supporters of the revolution against Banu Umayya
 - If somebody was forced into a nikkah does it count? His answer was no
 - This was the fatwa that got him tortured.
 - Abu Jasser Mansu was forcing people to give bayya, so the question
- Torture endured
 - They shaved his beard
 - Hung him from trees
 - Dragged him through the streets
 - He was in his old age
- His response
 - Although he could have collected people and started the revolution, he wanted to protect the sanctity of the haram
 - He would repeat this phrase often, that the people of deen needed to endure difficulty
 - The tyrannical governor was a descendent of Ibn Abbas, Malik refused to make dua against him since he was a relative
- Respect earned
 - The actual khalifa asked him if he wants revenge and his said no
 - They asked him his opinion on rebuilding the Kaaba
- Had wounds on his body until his death

Continuing his Legacy

- Aburrahman Al Qasid Al Atiqi
 - From Ramla, Palestine
 - Seige during the Prophet ﷺ's life, a slave

- From their descendants
- Ashhab
 - Ashhab did not like Imam Shafi'i, they as students disagreed to the extent that they got into fist fights
 - The scholars themselves were friends while their students fought.
 - Ashhab would make public dua for Imam Shafi'i's death.
 - Interestingly they both died in the same year
- Yahya bin Yahya
 - Narrator of Muwatta
 - Studied with Imam Malik in his last year of life
 - Malik had written it 20 years prior, but Yahya learned the last revision
 - When Malik was teaching, there was an elephant one day and all of the class ran to look. Yahya was the only one who stayed seated.
- Layth bin Saad
 - Contemporary
 - Had his own madhab
 - Students had tension but they were friends
 - He was more knowledgeable than Malik but his students were less dedicated
 - Passed away in Egypt
- Malik's commentary on his students
 - Used to give them gifts
 - Had a lot of respect for them
 - "Anyone who writes a single hadith from me, I am forever indebted to that person."
- Children
 - 2 sons and 1 daughter
 - Sons did not narrate, but his daughter narrated the whole muwatta very accurately
 - If knowledge is not through inheritance, than my daughter is an example that it is not
 - His daughter would be listening from outside and would knock on the door to correct mistakes
 - She gave fatwas in Madina
- Imam Mohammed
 - Studied with Imam Malik for 3 years
 - Was a narrator for Hanifa
 - Narrated the muwatta
- Imam Abu Yusuf 11:08

- Met malik and had some debates with him

Death

- 5th grandson of Ibn Abbas led the janazah
- His grave is in Baqi

Broken Muwatta

- Muwatta means agreed upon, well treaded path
- First book to be organized by chapters in such a way
- Musannaf (chapters)
- Before he narrated it, he presented it to all the mashaikh
- Malik's chain of narration is very short, only 2 people
 - Bukhari and Muslim did not become famous for compilation but in selecting exact wording. Muwatta is more authentic than either of them.
- Malik's muwatta contains some of his own commentary
- Some narrations were debated over their authenticity at first, but were later proven.
- Harun Rashid's offer
 - To make it the constitution
 - Malik refused, because sahaba disagreed and differences opinion existed for a reason
 - Malik preferred his own opinion but never claimed his alone to be correct, always acknowledging that other people could be right

Imam Bukhari

Imam Bukhari

Date Covered: 11/17 @ 1405

Background

- He is two generations after Imam Malik
- Mohammed ibn Ismail Ibn ???
- His great-grandfather was the first to accept islam, and he accepted it at the hands of the governor of Bukhara

Childhood

- His father died when he was young but left behind a lot of wealth, which Bukhari survived off of.
- He lost his eyesight in infancy, and his mother tells the story of how she was making dua and one night she saw Ibrahim AS in her dream telling her that his eyesight has been restored.
 - The Prophet ﷺ saw Ibrahim AS leaning on Bayt Al Mamour near children
 - There's lots of symbolism between Ibrahim AS and children
- Bukhari could read with very little light in the dark.
 - There is a connection between blindness and sharp memory.
 - His period of blindness might be why his memory was strong
- He started memorizing Quran and hadith at the age of 10.
- By the age of 16 he had memorized the books of Abdullah ibn Mubarak and ?, then he went for hajj.
- Everyone else returned except him; Bukhari stayed in Madina studying hadith.
- There, at the age of 18 he wrote a book At Tarikh Al Kabir (The Great History), which contains biographies of sahaba.
 - He mentions he wrote it in the rawdah.
- He travelled to many different regions to learn.
 - By the end of his life he had memorized more than 600,000 hadith.
 - Side Note: Ulama count every chain as its own hadith. Individual statements total to 35-40k, so when they memorized, they were memorizing the word changes.
 - He met 1,000+ Shuyukh

Scholarly Style

Teachers/Contemporaries/Students

- Imam Ahmed
- Ishaq Birrawi ?
- Contemporaries: missed 1416
- Students: Imam Muslim, Tirmidhi, Abu Dawud
- He compiled his collection and then edited over the course of 16 years.
 - During this time he also taught.

Unique Qualities

1. His standard of Selecting Narrators
 - He always chose the best of narrators. He only chose those who were the most accurate and specific.
2. Style of authorship
 - Only 2,000 individual wordings to the hadiths, but brought under different chapter headings.
 - His choice of presenting narrations would indicate his opinion on how strong the hadith is (while demonstrating his awareness of the hadith's existence)
 - The focus of Bukhari's texts is chapter headings. However they sometimes don't have titles.
 - Mufti Aasim's teacher Sheikh Yunus says that Bukhari's texts are a test for students, Bukhari wanted to see how his students could find meaning from it.

Sahih Al Bukhari

- Bukhari's shortest chain is 3 people, of which there are 22. For his generation of scholarship it is extremely short.
 - His longest chain was 9.

His Qualities

- **Cautious about halal wealth:** Would only accept certain money
- **Cautious about his reputation**
 - He was once on a ship with 1,000 dinars (equal to 500k)

- A man saw this and pretended to have lost his money
- He threw his money into the water, saying that his reputation was more important to him
- **Talent Archer:** Related to his good eyesight. Once he shot at the same spot on a bridge so many times that the pillar broke.
- **Worship:** He prayed 2 rakat for every hadith he wrote in Sahih.
- **Cautious in Criticizing Narrators**
 - Criticism was common at the time
 - His harshest criticism was “Fihi nadar” meaning “You need to look into this guy”
 - When Bukhari criticized a narrator it was a true sign they were unreliable
- **Build:** Average height, and skinny
- **Motivation:** He saw a dream of the Prophet ﷺ and he was swatting away flies from him. Someone interpreted it to mean he would preserve the prophet ﷺ's hadith. Narrations mention his mother had the dream.
- **Memory**
 - One time they asked him about 100 different hadith and claimed to know none. At the end he corrected all 100 of them.
 - Shows how impressive his memory was. People with memory like this still exist.

End of Life

- He was tortured to defend the view that the Quran has human-like traits. There was a large aqeedah crisis.
 - People would hold the Quran and say “This is not created”
 - However, paper, human voices, etc are all creation
- Bukhari wrote a book called Khalqu Alal Ibad to show that actions are a form of Allah's creation. TS 1431
 - Bukhari was then persecuted
 - Fellow scholars criticized him, such as his contemporary Mohammed bin Yahya Ad Dhuhari
 - Bukhari was then exiled
- Imam Muslim shipped back the hadith he learned from Dhuhari after he heard about what he said about Bukhari
- Bukhari died exiled and with a bad reputation
 - This shows that people's perceptions don't mean anything.
 - People can experience difficulty at any stage of their life.

Imam Muslim

Imam Muslim

Date Covered: 11/18 @ 1315

- Author of the second of the two most famous sahih collections
- **Full Name:** Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj al-Naysaburi
- **Born:** between 201-206
- **Death:** in 261

Childhood

- Started at the age of 12 with local scholars
 - **Lesson on starting local:** People get into the romantics of studying overseas without developing necessary qualities of a student of knowledge. It is more beneficial to learn locally first. Someone who has already studied will benefit the best, since people who have good habits at home will be good anywhere.
 - **Culture of Learning:** Some madaris look at their students' feet to check for bruising, because if they are already in the habit of studying there will be marks. They will not accept a student without them.
- Started travelling to study at the age of 14
 - He travelled widely and attended the gatherings of the most learned hadith scholars including Ishaq ibn Rahawayh, Ahmad bin Hanbal, and Imam Bukhari
 - His Sahif (personal hadith collection) has narrations from 200+ teachers.
 - For his work, he sifted through over 300,000 ahadith and selected 7,479 3,033 ahadith (if repetitions are excluded)
- There is limited information on him compared to Imam Malik and Imam Bukhari because he did not have as many students.

Scholarly Life/Style

- His style of writing was unique in that he included his own chains of narration.
- His collection will have multiple sources for each hadith
 - Difference from Bukhari: Bukhari would only present his best/strongest narrations.
- He organized the ahadith by subject matter and compiled all ahadith with various chains under one chapter.

- Muslim's collection includes all information in one place, and was very organized/clear.
- Some scholars prefer it for teaching because it is so straightforward.
- His system was more refined than Imam Bukhari's
 - Bukhari included hadith without the details of their chains.
 - Muslim would describe differences between his teachers and was very precise in detailing the difference in their wordings.
 - Bukhari was writing his collection on-the-go while Muslim did it at home, after collecting everything.
 - Hence, he had his work in front of him and was able to check it, as opposed to relying on memory.
 - Muslim only has 12 statements from sahaba.
- He was inspired to compile his work because the works of hadith that were available were difficult to use
 - He also wrote a detailed introduction which in itself holds valuable information.
 - He explains his process of inclusion/collection, and often includes his own explanations.
- Muslim has few reports from his students, where Sahih Bukhari has some.
 - Muslim was known for not speaking much.
- He also did it to defend the sunnah of the Prophet SAW
- It took him 15 years to compile his work

Differences and Disagreements with Bukhari

- Later in life they disagreed on accepting "an ana"
 - An ana means ??
- Bukhari was of the opinion that the person claiming the hadith needs two witnesses
- Muslim on the other hand gave benefit to the narrators meeting each other
- They had a back and forth
 - However, Muslim still had a lot of respect for his teacher (to the extent that he shipped back teachings of another teacher who insulted Bukhari)
 - They didn't necessarily always meet each others standards
 - When hadith studies get complex enough, they reach such a level of dispute where small details are discussed.

Tirmidhi/Dawud/An Nasai/Ibn Majah

Tirmidhi/Dawud/An Nasai/Ibn Majah

Date Covered: 11/18 @ 1330, 11/19 @ 1400

Imam Tirmidhi

- Mentions that he compiled his book from 300 narrators
- His biography is very short
- His memory was very sharp
 - He was once verifying his hadith in front of his teacher, and his paper was blank. He repeated back 40-50 hadith exactly how it was said to him.
 - He was tested again, did 40 more with unique chains.
 - He repeated immediately
- His book was very accessible
 - His goal was to provide evidences for fuquha
 - He wanted it to be clear for understanding fiqh, as if the Prophet ﷺ was in front of the leader telling them how to do something
- He would include which previous scholars were in agreement about the topic
- He says about his Jami'i
 - There are only two hadith which I have never seen acted on: the hadd punishment for alcohol and the hadith about ?? 1336
- Sheikh mentions it was an enjoyable read for him, because it held a lot of commentary and showed how his students considered him.
- Innovations
 - He was one of the first to use certain terminology
 - Ex: Hasan meaning good, for grading hadith

Imam Abu Dawud

- From Tajikistan
- His goal in his book was to gather as many opinions as he can
 - Ex: Say there are 10 ways to pray a certain way.
 - His goal was to be very extensive in details of ruling
 - Some scholars say if you removed all other books this one would be sufficient (due to its comprehensive nature)
- He sent a letter to Madina saying that any hadith he does not claim to be weak.

Sunan An-Nasai

- Spent most of life in Falastin, Ramla
- Ramla's governor asked him to write hadith books
- He wrote Sunan Kubra
- He summarized into Al-Mujtaba
- Bukhari Muslim then Sunnan Nasai in order of strictness
- He is at times stricter than Muslim
- His chapter headings are similar to Bukhari
 - He will mention how students narrated certain topics
- He was also involved in the politics of Sham

Imam Ibn Majah

- The most controversial to be considered in the top 6 books of hadith.
- After a long time he got added, because he has the lowest standard
- His goal was to collect fabricated hadiths and weak ones as well
 - However some of the hadith he claims fabricated are actually not
 - People wrote books about these hadith and their fabrication
- However he has a lot of unique narrations and details.

Regarding All of the Scholars

- Between these 7, there was debate.
- We owe these hadith scholars for putting in the work of preservation and collection.
- They each had their own goals with their collections.

Summary of the 6 Sunan Al Sughra

1. Sahih Bukhari
2. Sahih Muslim
3. Jami'i At Tirmidhi
4. Sunan Abu Dawud
5. Sunan An Nasai

6. Either: Muwatta Imam Malik OR Sunan Ibn Majah (debated)

Table of Books

Al Sihah Al Sittah

Title of Book	Unique Feature	Goal of Author
Sahih Bukhari	Chapter headings	Highest levels of authenticity
Sahih Muslim	Presentation/organization of chains of narration + introduction	Ease of use compared to other hadith works
Jami'i At Tirmidhi	Bringing opinions/commentary of fuqaha	Provide evidence and clarity in fiqh "As if the Prophet ﷺ was standing in front of them"
Sunan Abu Dawud	Extremely comprehensive coverage of hadith related to rulings "Some scholars say if you removed all other books this one would be sufficient (due to its comprehensive nature)"	To gather as many opinions as he can
Sunan An Nasai	Strict standards (on par with Bukhari and Muslim)	Collection (per the request of the governor of Ramla)
Sunan Ibn Majah	Introduction	To collect unique narrations and details that can't be found in other books
Muwatta Imam Malik	First to organize by chapters + short chain	To provide evidence for his points in fiqh

Chapter 6: Al-Isnad

Chapter 6: Al-Isnad

Date Covered: 12/2 @ 1356

Origins of Isnad

- The Word Isnad
 - Meaning connection
- No other science similar to it
 - The closest thing to it in secular society is the passing of evidence in court.
 - People do not care enough about any other discipline to track down how information was preserved.
- Motivation for Isnad: Preserving the words of the Prophet ﷺ and maintaining the authenticity of hadith
- Unique to this Ummah: previous peoples did not engage in any kind of tangible protection
- Isnad is just the study of verification through chains
 - As time has gone on we have a greater need for preservation, however it is less and less within our control.
 - Tracking efforts in maintaining chains of narration and understanding its rules
- Words that are used
 - There are very specific words used to indicate how people met each other and how they narrated to each other
 - Ex: a hadith in Sahih Muslim in which he narrates from two different people. The students of Abu Huraira totaled 13, who then narrated to another 16, who all have varying levels of reliability. This is part of the mechanism of isnad.

Chapter 7: Critique and Validation

Chapter 7: Biographies of Narrators/ Critique and Validation

Date Covered: 12/2 @ 1400, 12/3 @ 1400

Key terms

Jarh

Tadeel

Adala

Dhabt

Ilm Al Rijal (Knowledge of Narrators)

- Literal meaning is “knowledge of men”
 - Does not negate women as narrators
 - Generically referring to the study of the lives of narrators
- Describes the biographies, characteristics, and reliability of the narrators
 - Hadith is a very serious subject, hence why when scholars decided to start narrating they opened their lives to being scrutinized with intensity

Slide Notes

- 'Ilm al-Rijal is a branch of hadith studies which deals with biographies of narrators
 - Deals mainly with biographical data, chronology, life histories, academic achievements, teachers, students, school of following, political views, etc.
 - Deals with information that is relevant to the narrator’s reliability and character
 - Also deals with the generation and time frame that the narrator lived in
 - Place of birth and place of death helped to determine if the chain of hadith was connected or not.
 - One of the earliest works in this field was Kitab al-Tabaqat al-Kabir by ibn Sa’d al-Zuhri
 - Contains biographies of over 4,000 narrators

- Imam Bukhari's al-Tarikh al-Kabir dealt with over 40,000 narrators, but no complete manuscript of this work exists
- To judge just based of someone biography is not that common, it was a supplement to other forms of verification

Jarh wa Tadil (Critique and Validation)

- The judging of narrators by the quality of their narrations (accuracy, standards and memory etc.)
- Example of Baqi ibn Makhlad
 - One of the students of Imam Ahmed
 - Traveled from Spain on foot to him, and found him in house arrest. When he knocked on his door, Imam Ahmed responded that he was not allowed to narrate and would be imprisoned
 - He then proposed to be a beggar. Imam Ahmed said he was not allowed to sit in other circles and he agreed.
 - He knocked and learned one hadith a day for 300 days
 - When Imam Ahmed got released he honored Baqi a lot, and Baqi was a scholar of his own respects
 - One time he asked Ali Madina about Imam Ahmed and he was in disbelief that Imam Ahmed's narrations would even be asked about
 - This was the culture of narration
- It was not acceptable to slander each other out of personal issues
 - They kept their personal problems with each other out of their business of narration
 - This is one of the only cases where backbiting is technically permitted but even then there is caution

Slide notes

- Al-Jarh wa al-Ta'dil refers to critique and validation
 - Concerned mainly with the reliability and unreliability of hadith narrators
 - Compiles information which either proves them to be reliable or unreliable
- Al-Ta'dil
 - means establishing a narrator as upright in the moral sense and reliable in terms of memory and accuracy
- Al-Jarh

- means to wound
- Refers to declaring a hadith narrator as having suspect character and being unreliable
- Works in this field started appearing in the 3rd century, however hadith narrator criticism and isnad evaluation began from the era of the Companions
 - Ex: Formal hadith criticism was carried out by the giants of the 2nd century such as Shu'bah ibn al-Hajjaj, Malik ibn Anad, Sufyan al-Thawri, and Sufyan ibn Uyaynah
- Whenever the reliability of a narrator is questioned and there is investigation into their character, two things can happen
 - Available information proves that there are reliable (ta'dil)
 - Available information proves them to be unreliable (jarh)
- In order for a hadith to be authentic, it is not enough for the text to be accurate, but the narrators must be upright, credible, and accurate
- To determine these factors, scholars of hadith set a criteria that allowed them to grade hadith narrators as reliable or unreliable.

Targets of Criticism

- When analyzing a narrator, the scholars of hadith looked at two major factors:
 - Al-'Adalah (moral uprightness)
 - Al-Dabt (Accuracy)

Adalah (uprightness)

- Meaning uprightness
 - Indicating their character and evaluation of them being a good person

Targets of Uprightness

1. Khidb (lying)
2. Ittiham al khidb (accusation of lying)
 - Even entering a situation which led to a bad reputation in dealings
3. Fisq (open sin)
4. Jahalah (being unknown)

- The standard is that the person is neutral until their reputation is proven to be good, giving strength to their narrations
- 5. Bidah (innovation)
 - The most important condition was that the nature of the bidah was not related to making sins permissible, taking them out of the folds of islam, or generally extreme.
 - If they had foundational beliefs which are extreme or contradictory, and they are using their narration to support their belief

Dhabt (precision)

Precision of Two Things

1. **Kitab** (in their writing)
2. **Sadr** (in their memory)

Targets of Precision

Ghafilah (negligence): they know the information but they slip by accident. A minimal mistake.

Fush Al Ghalat (severe errors); errors which change the meaning of what is being said. Will tarnish their reputation for precision.

Mukhalafa Al Thiqat (contradiction with others): when the narration contradicts the narration of someone who is very reliable

Wahm (misunderstanding): being known for misunderstanding or confusion.

Su' al hifz (bad memory)

There are more targets but these are the most important

Chapter 8: Classification by Authority

Chapter 8: Classification by Authority

Date Covered: 12/3 @ 1400

This chapter covers the different kinds of hadith based on who said it.

1. Hadith Qudsi

Core Qualities

- Speaker is Allah
- Words do not have to be exact
- Can be weak or fabricated

Differences between Quran and Hadith Qudsi

- Quran MUST be
 - Narrated by large amount of people
 - Sahih (authentic)
- Mass transmission
 - Quran: mutawattir
 - Qudsi: not necessarily mass transmitted
- Wording
 - Quran: is the exact speech of Allah
 - Qudsi: he Prophet ﷺ may be summarizing in hadith qudsi
- Reward of Recitation
 - Quran: has reward
 - Qudsi: does not
- Fabrication/Divine Protection
 - Quran: cannot be fabricated
 - Qudsi: can be. Requires verification of authenticity
- Content
 - Qudsi generally will not have any rulings
 - Identifying Qudsi: The Prophet ﷺ will say "Qalallah (Allah said...)"

2. Hadith Marfoo

Core Qualities

- Marfoo means lifted/raised
- Statements of the prophet ﷺ

Types of Hadith Marfoo

1. Al Marfoo Al Qawli; the Prophet ﷺ said xyz
 2. Al Marfoo Al Fi'li; the Prophet ﷺ was seen doing xyz
 3. Al Marfoo Al Taqrir: the Prophet ﷺ saw the action and did not stop it
 - Needs to be verified that the Prophet ﷺ actually saw it
 - Story of drawing Fiqh: A child led salah for his tribe since he had the most memorize, he was so poor that his clothing did not cover his body in salah. A woman saw and they bought him a shawl and he said it was one of his best days. Many fiqh are drawn from this.
 4. Al Marfoo Al Wasfi: Descriptions of the Prophet ﷺ
- Descriptions of sahabi are not necessarily given the same weight as hadith

3. Hadith Al Mawquf

- Sometimes statements of sahabi are given the same weight as hadith
 - The only way they could've heard it is from the Prophet ﷺ
 - Example: Statement of Ibn Abbas
- Exception: sahaba who narrated from israeli riwayat

4. Hadith Al Maqtu

- Statements of the tabi'een
- Meaning of the word maqtu
 - comes from qata'a
 - means to cut or sever
 - refers to a saying or action attributed to a tabi'een
- Example of Hasan Al-Basri RA:
 - Statement regarding praying behind an innovator
 - "Pray and his innovation is upon him."
- Example of Masruq ibn al-Ajda' RA

- 'It is sufficient for a person to be considered a scholar if he fears Allah and for a person to be ignorant if he boasts with his knowledge.'
- It has been narrated that Masruq RA would draw a curtain between him and his family, turn towards prayer and leave them and their affairs.

Chapter 9+10: Classification by Number/Narrators

Chapter 9 +10: Classification by Number/Narrators

Date Covered: 12/4 @ 1405

Two Main Types

1. Mutawattir
2. Ahaad

Defining Mutawattir

- The goal is to identify if it is possible for them to have lied about, because it is easy for a group of people to come in a room and agree on a fabricated story.
- Example a reliable mutawattir
 - Sahaba from different regions, none of whom know each other, narrating the same hadith to their students are very unlikely to have conspired

Subtype: Manawi

- Mutawattir in meaning
 - Often regarding his characteristics, miracles (water coming from his fingers, with animals etc.)
- Those narrations have little debate but their wording might not be exactly the same
- The moon splitting has debate
- Al-Mutawattir al-Ma'nawi: Mutawattir in Meaning The wording of this hadith itself may not be mutawattir, but there are so many other narrations that talk about the same thing subject, or topic that it is considered to be mutawattir One example of this is all of the various narrations about raising one's hand during the time of supplication There are a number of ahadith that confirm this, and although each one taken individually is not mutawattir, the common theme becomes mutawattir There are almost 100 ahadith that confirm this This type of tawatur is established for a number of acts of worship such as the way to perform wudu, how the imam leads salah, and how hajj should be performed.

Subtype: Lafdhi

- This refers to mutawatir hadith that consists of the verbatim transmission of the sayings of the Prophet ﷺ. The exact words are agreed upon.
- Mutawatir in general is rare across hadith.
 - The most widely mutawattir with no variations in wording is actually about narrating false hadiths
- Ex: The Prophet SAW said: "Whoever tells a lie upon me intentionally then let them prepare their seat in the Hellfire." This hadith has been narrated by a number of companions. Other companions narrated it from them, and then their students, and their students, and so on. Scholars of hadith differed with respect to the existence and scope of this type of narration. Some scholars claimed that this type of hadith does not exist and others said that they are rare. However the vast majority of scholars including Ibn Hajar al-'Asqalani, Ibn Hazm al-Zahiri, Qadi Iyad, and Jalal al-Din al-Suyuti maintain that these narrations are not rare. Jalal al-Din al-Suyuti authored a book entitled al-Azhaar al-Mutanathira fi al-Akhbaar al-Mutawatirah (Scattered Flowers within Mutawatir Reports). He later summarized in Qatf al-Azhaar (Plucking the Flowers). In this book he tried to compile a number of mutawatir ahadith.

Defining Ahaad

- Opposite of mutawaatir in that it did not reach mass transmission
- At some point in the chain it became weak. The weakness is distinguished by how many people narrated.
 - Gharib: one narrator
 - Aziz: two narrators
 - Mashoor: 3+ but not reaching mutawattir
- Even if it was mutawattir at some point, if the chain of narrations dips it will reduce its status.
- The basis of the report is sensory perception not ? term missed 1423
- It can still be used for fiqh and can still be considered authentic.
- Contradictory statements. Mutawattir will take preference over ahaad.

Al Mashoor

- At least 3 narrators at every link in the chain but not reaching mutawattir

Al Aziz

- Two examples from Imam Muslim. In which he references two narrators who said the same thing.

Gharib

- Muthlaq: only one sahabi narrating it
 - Many hadith of Aisha RA for example are muthlaq because she was the only person to see it
- Nisbi: later in the chain there is only one narrator
 - For example if 5 sahaba narrate it to 10 people after them, but from them only 1 person continues the chain.

Chapter 11: Authenticity and Weakness

Chapter 11: Authenticity and Weakness

Date Covered: 12/9 @ 1400, 12/10 @ 1400, 12/15 @ 1455

Classification by Strength and Weakness

- Grading system for the strength of the narrators
- Not grading the wording of the hadith
- If a person of weak memory or common fabrications narrates it, it will have a low grade
- Refers to the probability of the Prophet ﷺ actually saying it
 - It's possible that the hadith is real but all of their narrations will be considered fabricated because one fabricator's name is in the chain
 - The only hadith with 100% authenticity are the ones that are mutawaatir ladhfi
 - You would not say that the hadith are weak but rather that the authenticity is weak.
- The scholars differed on their grading scales
 - Depends on how much trust they had in the person's narrations
 - Gradings are an oversimplification

The 5 Grades

Grade 1: Sahih (li dhatihi)

Main Qualifiers for Sahih

1. Ittisal: meaning connected. Every person in the chain met the person that is after them.
 2. Aadala: meaning character. See section.
 3. Dhabt: precision writing and memory. See section.
 4. Alam Ashuludh: absence of content contradictions
 5. l'illa: absence of hidden flaws. (A defect might be in the narrator taking advantage of people's assumptions about the narration.) l'illa is a field of its own.
- The 7 levels of sahih slide
 - Not actually true. It doesn't matter who mentions it

- These 7 levels only have value because Bukhari and Muslim were very strict

Grade 2: Sahih ghayr

- A hasan hadith that is corroborated in many other sahih hadith
- All together it make it authentic
- Ghayrihi means external support
- On its own its not that strong but with the support it becomes sahih ghayr

Grade 3: Hasan

- All the criteria met, but weaker in dhabt
- The narrator maybe has some weak points in their character and work

Grade 4: Hasan li ghayrihi

- Originally daif, but corroborated by other narrations to be hasan
- Doesn't have to be the exact same wordings, just same in meaning
- The original weakness has to be very minimal
- It cannot be a severe form of weakness

Grade 5: Daif

Qualities which make it Daif

- Fabricator in the chain
 - If you have 10 authentic narrators and one fabricator, the whole chain becomes daif
 - One fabricator can make the whole chain daif
- Khawarim al muru'u: deficiencies in character)
 - Under the umbrella of adala
 - Even if they have a small deficiency in their conduct it drops their adala
 - For example, eating while standing up or being seen eating in public (which they considered undignified)
 - In summary: includes things that are publicly considered strange or embarrassing
- Inqita Itarrawi: Breaks in the chain

- If the narrator did not hear it directly from the previous narrator
- Subjective: depends on how severe the gap is, the traits of the narrator
- Some tabi'een might not have met the Prophet ﷺ, but their narration does not include who they heard it from
- This weakens the narration.
- Sometimes it also depends on the habits of the narrators, who would not narrate if it was not from a sahaba. For such a narrator it is not a big weakness.

Terminology for Weak Hadith

Terms for Breaks in Chain

1. Muallak: no chain of narration
 - entire chain is missing except the end (last person to narrate it)
 - Bukhari does this often
 - By standard it is weak, but can become authentic very easily by researching the chain
2. Mursal: where a tabi'een says "The Prophet ﷺ said ..."
3. Mu'dal: two or more narrators dropped in the chain
4. Munqati: umbrella term for breaks in chain
5. Mudallas: the narrator purposefully drops the person that they heard it from

- They want cut out the middle man to make the narration seem more authentic
- It was a big deal because it made it very difficult to authenticate
- A type of intentional break in the chain that could easily be hidden
- Not always considered an issue with adala

Q&A

- In the generation of Imam Malik the chain was short, and with each generation the chain got longer. It's all based on what reaches a specific muhaddith. It is very important to look at all the chains.
- For scholars who were being persecuted
- During Imam Ahmed's life his situation changed
- True until you have a reason to doubt
- Tadlees has its own field of study under uloom al fiqh

5 Narrator Weaknesses

- Not Acceptable: Mawdu
 - when there is a narrator that is known to have fabricated
 - Entire studies written about why fabrications came to be
 - Often there were political motivations
 - Some even fabricated virtuous things, maybe to motivate people
 - Ex: virtues of reciting Quran, or of certain clothing or food (which they happen to sell)
 - Nobody can say with full confidence however that it is fabricated. Though they may not be reliable, there is no guarantee and always a chance of it being right.
 - No certainty in jazm or in sahih

Ways to Identify Fabrication

1. Person in the chain is known for lying/fabricating
2. If the meaning has an inconsistency
3. If the tone is far-fetched (the Prophet ﷺ does not speak like that)
 - Not as exact of a science as the others
 - Some people are quicker to claim fabrications than others

- Ibn Al Jawzi for example wrote a book which includes many that are not.
- **Extremely Weak: Matruk**
 - an extremely weak narrator due to fasiq (open sin)
 - One person in the chain is enough
 - It will be do
- **Very Weak: Munkar**
 - two definitions
 - Very close to matruk. Narrators that are very weak due to sinful behavior
 - OR if the weak narrator contradicts the stronger narrator (but this is not as bad. Much easier to prove)
- **Weakly Authentic: Shadh**
 - Both narrators are authentic but one has a contradictory narration
 - The stronger one is called maarouf (more authentic) the weaker one is shadh (authentic)
 - Opposite of shadh is mahfudh
 - Easy to fix
- **Hidden Weakness: Muallal**
 - Presence of hidden defects, like tadlis (dropped chain)

4 Types of Muallal (Hidden Defects)

- **Mudraj/Idraj**
 - The narrator's words are confused with the original statement
 - When the style of narrating is ambiguous and you don't know who is talking
 - Example: Hadith about Adam being 60 cubits tall and people are getting smaller.
 - Said to be idraj, because a tabieen said they kept getting smaller, not the Prophet ﷺ but it was recorded as if the Prophet ﷺ said it
 - Trick to finding it: compare the narration with the narrations of other students
- **Maqlub/Qalb**
 - Can happen in the sanad or the matn
 - One type: Flipping names in the chain
 - Second type: giving the wrong chain
 - Easy to fix, find the correct chain
 - Third type: in wording. Ex: order of the word list is mixed

- Mudtarib
 - Two narrators of equal authenticity are contradicting each other in an unresolvable manner
 - Ex Shuaba and Sufyan
 - The contradiction can be in the chain or in the detail
 - Very difficult to solve.
 - Qara'in: Look at outside factors. Asking as many people, and get a majority opinion. Or look at other hadith.
 - Usually both narrations cannot exist at the same time due to a concept known as tawfiq (reconciliation) but it does not work for mudtarib
- Musahhaf
 - Mistake in harakat or dots which leads to a difference in meaning
 - Hadith: the permissibility of eating a fetus cow that was slaughtered in the mother cow is halal
 - A type of weakness that is very easy to fix
- Shadeed ad Dhabt: extremely weak
- Weakness is a spectrum from bad memory
- Very pious people, who didn't study hadith, would not be held to the same standard
- This is very low form of weakness
- Narrators on the other end
- Mursal is a very light form of weakness
- For something to become hasan li ghayrihi while having mursal

Chapter 12: Action/Use of Weak Hadith

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Date Covered: 12/15 @ 1534

Scholarly Use of Weak Hadith

- Certain types of weakness can be used for certain things
- Yahya ibn Main, Bukhari, Muslim
 - Have all used weak hadith at some point
- Ibn Hazan
 - Strongly rejects weak hadith
 - Can be contested, has used them sometimes
- Some recent movements claiming weak hadith to be on the same level as fabricated
 - Minority opinion
- In the world of muhadditheen weak hadith are frequent
 - They understood that there is no guarantee of it being false, mistakes happen, etc.
 - They attribute weakness out of caution not rejection
- Our standards of accepting information are much lower in general
- Moderate view of overwhelming majority
 - Ulama of hadith were more lenient in anything that was not mawdu
 - Mawdu is haram, but everything else had leniency
 - Conveying weakness is a courtesy
 - Only on matters of halal/haram and aqeedah is it mandatory
- Fiqh and aqeedah
 - Bulletproof narrators only
 - Other matters can be narrated about with ease

Conditions for Use of Weak Hadith

Rule 0: Not being used for fiqh or aqeedah

1. Details of seerah (names, dates, numbers of people, etc.)
 - Very common to be weak
 - Has lots of leniency
 - But cannot be extremely weak
2. Virtues
 - Cannot be extremely weak
 - Must coincide with existing knowledge of virtues

- Cannot be definitively attributed to the Prophet ﷺ
- People might say “It has been narrated...”